

# Katrina *Engelsted*

katrina@engelsted.co

774·239·8699

linkedin.com/in/katrinae

github.com/MappingKat

Boulder, CO · Mountain Time · US-remote

## RE: SOLUTIONS ENGINEER – OVERSTORY

Hi Overstory team,

I'm writing to apply for the Solutions Engineer role. Most cover letters for this kind of position have to argue that the candidate is geospatial-adjacent and climate-adjacent. **Mine doesn't have to argue anything** — Overstory is the exact intersection of three things I've already spent my career inside. Three reasons:

- 1 The Teren / Solspec parallel.** Three years at **Teren (formerly Solspec)** as Head of Marketing Tech — we were building **ML layers from drone imagery of utility right-of-ways** to identify **problematic surface hydrology, encroachments, and noxious weeds**. Different sensor platform (drone vs. satellite), same product shape Overstory builds. The closest analog to your actual work in my background.
- 2 Geospatial depth, going back to college.** Studied GIS at Colgate with internships at **Humanitarian OpenStreetMap Team, Bonobo Conservation Initiative**, and an **oil-palm remote-sensing project in Indonesia** (mapping farm boundaries, obligate forest habitats, and tree counts from satellite imagery). Then 3 yrs at the **National Park Service** on the NPS Park Tiles team — custom mapping for **wildfire perimeters** and endangered-species habitat. Honors thesis in spatial statistics on top.
- 3 Utility customer fluency + AI day-job.** Two years founding tech advisor at **Upstream AI**, a small water-utility software startup — different utility than electric, but I know utility procurement, operator language, regulatory baselines from the inside. My actual day-to-day there is building **Claude Code sub-agents, RAG pipelines, and embedding similarity** for non-technical end-users. The AI-tooling bonus is the work I do now.

On the customer-facing piece — that's been my preference for fifteen years, not just my job description. I've been customer-facing since Homebot (Solutions Engineering Mgr, early team) and Lytics (Sr. Tech Consultant on the Whirlpool graph-identity engagement). **Solving tech problems alongside customers is the most effective contribution I know.**

Python-first analyst (pandas, scikit-learn, statsmodels, daily). Jupyter, git/GitHub, command-line workflows. Vector + raster comfort goes back to NPS cartography. SQL daily across Postgres, Supabase, BigQuery, and one published Snowflake project.

→ [engelsted.co/overstory.html](https://engelsted.co/overstory.html)

Long-form version of this letter — JD line-by-line mapping, four-move framework on how I'd run a customer engagement, and full project receipts.

Boulder, MT — one hour off your EST preference, fully aligned with EST working hours when needed. Full-time available. Happy to walk through the Teren / Solspec ROW work or the NPS wildfire-mapping projects on a call.

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